

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Cognizant Internship – 2026



1. What is Internship?

An internship is an opportunity for all campus selects to achieve business readiness even before you onboard with Cognizant. Each intern spends a certain number of training hours across core skills, hands-on learning, and behavioral learning. Additionally, you will work on business-aligned use cases as part of your project component during the project phase, along with the required training to become more competent from a technology standpoint.

2. When will an intern join as a Full-Time Employee (FTE)?

Based on performance during Internship and business demand, the intern's onboarding as full-time employee will be prioritized.

3. Are interns expected to rejoin as 'Full Time Employee (FTE)' after completion of the internship?

Post successful completion of Internship and meeting the completion criteria, Interns are eligible to rejoin Cognizant as a Full Time Employees. Candidates will be formally notified of the Joining date, which will align with business demands and the availability of their college provisional certificate.

4. Can an intern skip the internship offer and join Cognizant later? Will it affect the joining date?

The Cognizant Internship, being a pre-joining skill and capability development program, forms a critical part of your employment with Cognizant. Prior to joining Cognizant, you must successfully complete the prescribed internship program. In the event of non-completion of the internship, Cognizant may, at its sole discretion, revoke this offer of employment.

However, the faster you get skilled, the more it may help expedite your onboarding.

If an intern offer is rejected, the candidate is marked as 'Declined' in the pipeline and hence will not be considered for upcoming onboardings. In case of absence on the intern onboarding date of joining (DOJ) without a valid reason, the candidate will also be marked as 'Declined' in the pipeline and will not be considered for further onboarding.

5. Why should an intern join the internship, and what are the benefits of Internship program?

An internship is a great platform to jump-start your career. It offers a unique opportunity to gain skills that make them business ready. There are various benefits,

ranging from working on business cases to earning a stipend. However, we emphasize business-focused learning as the key factor that should encourage you to pursue an internship.

Below are a few benefits for your understanding:

- Acts as a launchpad to the corporate world
- Work on business-aligned use cases
- Learn and work with Subject Matter Experts (SMEs)
- Opportunity to interact with leaders
- Participate in technical (hackathons, code challenges) and fun events
- Interns will receive stipend every month.

6. What is the duration of the entire internship?

Our internship aligns with the curriculum track duration, ranging from 3 to 4 months, to which the interns are mapped. The track mapping is based on the candidate's skill profiling, and in some instances, it may be based on demand requirements. We will be able to decide the tracks only at the time of internship onboarding.

7. Will the duration of the entire internship vary from track to track?

Yes, the duration of the internship may vary (it can be less than 3 months for some tracks) based on your hiring assessment and evaluation, and it may also differ according to the curriculum track duration.

8. What are the timings of this internship program?

Training will be conducted from Monday through Friday from 8:30 am to 6:30 pm (IST). Interns can use Saturdays to catch up on learning and assignments provided.

9. What are the expectations from an Intern?

We expect you to

- Complete your learning/assessment's/Hands-on as per the given schedule.
- Get sufficiently equipped to deliver quality work.
- Adhere to the organization's policies and complete the given assignment(s) on time.
- Update your Batch owner on college assignments/project review schedule/ exam schedule etc and inform leave plans well in advance

10. What exactly will an intern undergo in the internship?

An intern will undergo a learning curriculum as per the learning track assigned. The

learning path will include in-depth sessions, hands-on exercises, and project work. There will also be a series of webinars, quizzes, SME interactions, mentor connects, code challenges, etc., to accelerate your learning.

11. Will the Internship be conducted on the Cognizant campus?

Yes, Cognizant offers internships that are conducted on their campus.

12. What are the components that constitute a milestone as part of the internship?

Milestones will be based on the learning track assigned to you with components like:

- Continuous learning with hands on exercises
- Code challenges
- Integrated Capability Test with knowledge and skill-based assessments

- Stage1/Delta assessment
- Business aligned project
- Interim evaluation
- Final evaluation

Candidates are required to spend Monday to Friday from 8:30 am to 6:30 pm (IST) for a period of 3 to 4 months, depending on the track assigned.

13. Will Cognizant evaluate an intern's performance during the internship?

Yes, performance will be reviewed, evaluated and communicated on a regular basis.

14. What is the consequence if an intern drops out of the Internship mid-way?

It is mandatory for Cognizant LOI-accepted candidates onboarded as interns to successfully complete the internship by meeting the completion criteria to be eligible for onboarding as full-time employees (FTE). In case of discontinuity from the internship without a valid reason, Cognizant may, at its sole discretion, revoke the offer of employment.

15. Can an intern get the solution sheet for each evaluation to understand their errors?

No, solution sheet will not be shared with the interns as per Cognizant's compliance policy, but scores will be shared.

16. Are interns allowed to attend college sessions periodically?

Yes, interns can attend college sessions provided they are available for all training sessions in person. Interns can also plan college activities during the weekend. In the case of mid-term exams, they must inform in advance with at least one month's notice for us to plan accordingly.

17. Are interns entitled to take leave?

No, there are no leaves during the internship. We strongly recommend interns avoid taking leaves during the internship. However, in case of emergencies or college exams, they can do so by informing the Batch owner/mentor well in advance. An 85% attendance rate every month during the internship is one of the qualifications to graduate from the program.

18. Do interns can get any holidays during the internship?

Yes, national, and regional holidays will be available as per the location-specific Cognizant holiday calendar.

19. Are interns allowed to attend a mid-term and final exams during the internship?

Yes, interns will be allowed for mid-term exams. However, they are required to inform us at least four weeks in advance prior to the exam dates. It is the responsibility of the intern to catch up on all the pending learnings and assignments missed during the mid-term exams.

20. Are trainees expected to follow a dress code while in training?

Yes, trainees will need to adhere to the Cognizant Dress Code policy. Any violation of this policy will call for actions. The dress code policy will be shared during the internship orientation.

21. Are interns entitled to receive a stipend during the Internship?

Yes, during this period, you will be provided a stipend of INR 12,000 per month, which will be paid monthly aligned with the duration of the Internship learning

curriculum, except for the last payment, which will be made after successful completion of the internship.

22. Will there be any deduction in the stipend if leaves are availed?

Yes, the stipend will be deducted for the leaves availed.

23. If an intern completes the learning as per the milestone without joining the daily sessions in person, will they be eligible for the stipend?

No, interns need to attend daily sessions in person and complete the milestone as required.

24. What is the reason for the deduction in the stipend amount, and how to get back the deducted amount?

There is a 10% tax deduction in the stipend. Form 16 will be sent to interns after internship completion, and interns can claim the deduction from the income tax department.

25. If interns provide tax saving investment proof, will the entire stipend be paid without tax deduction?

Since Interns will not be able to submit tax investment proofs in the system, taxes will be deducted at source on the stipend amount. For tax refunds, interns would be provided Form 16 to claim the same.

26. Is there any allowance other than the stipend?

No, there are no other allowances apart from the stipend during the internship period.

27. How will the stipend be paid?

It will be credited to the individual bank account. Interns must have a personal bank account in their name, and the account should be created in any nationalized bank or private sector bank in India. It cannot be a joint account with any family members.

28. Can the technology be chosen directly for the internship project?

Allocation of the technology track depends on the following: student capability, business demand, and the location where it can be offered. Student capability is assessed through electives completed by the student, participation in other technical forums, and performance during the internship.

29. How are the interns mapped to various technology tracks?

Technology mapping is carried out based on the candidate's skill profiling, and in some instances, it may be based on demand requirements and performance in tests and interviews conducted by Cognizant.

30. During the internship, what kind of projects will an intern be involved in?

The projects completed during the internship will vary from development to enhancements, research, and scripting across technologies like Java, .NET, AWS, Cloud, FSD, DW, Selenium, SFDC, and SAP. Projects in the Application Development space require good programming skills. Some of them would require digital skills as well. These projects are a combination of business-aligned cases that we deliver to our clients or internal projects to address Cognizant's business needs.

31. As a part of the internship, what will be the learning curriculum assigned to an intern?

An intern will undergo a learning curriculum as per the learning path assigned. The learning path will include in-depth sessions, hands-on exercises, and project work. There will also be a series of webinars, quizzes, SME interactions, mentor connects, code challenges, assessments, etc., to accelerate learning. The performance during the internship will be monitored through learning progress and continuous evaluations.

32. Will Cognizant provide a final semester project?

No, Cognizant will not provide a final semester project.

33. Is it possible to get the source code for final project submission as required by the college?

No, as per our compliance policy, no source code will be provided by Cognizant.

34. Is there a specific request from my college/university to do academy projects related to specialization in Engineering (Non-CS students – Circuit & Non-Circuit), how can participation be initiated in the internship?

No, as per Cognizant's corporate security policy, we will not provide final semester/academy projects.

35. Will cognizant provide the required infrastructure (hardware/software) to pursue the internship?

Yes, Cognizant will provide the required infrastructure for the training.

36. Will Cognizant provide an internet allowance while pursuing the internship?

No, internet allowance will not be provided by Cognizant.

37. Will the onboarding initiate as soon as the internship completes?

Based on performance during the internship and the business demand, the onboarding as a full-time employee will be prioritized. The candidates will be formally notified on the joining date aligning to the business demand and availability of Provisional Certificate.

38. Can an Intern take a break for a month or two after the internship is over and before joining cognizant as a full-time employee?

No, Cognizant offer is done based on business demand, and an intern needs to join as per the date requested.

39. How critical is internship completion for onboarding to Cognizant?

The onboarding with Cognizant would be prioritized based on the successful completion of the internship. In the event of non-completion of the internship, Cognizant may, at its sole discretion, revoke this offer of employment.

40. What is the consequence of plagiarism and misconduct during the internship?

Cognizant may, at its sole discretion, revoke this offer of employment as there is

zero tolerance for plagiarism and misconduct during the internship.

41. Can there be any flexibility on the assessment dates? Can an intern reschedule the assessments owing to a leave which has been availed due to certain exigency?

There is no flexibility on the assessment dates. In case the intern is lagging behind schedule due to certain exigency, they can take up the assessment in the catch-up calendar.

42. Can milestone dates for assignment and MFPE (My First Pod Engagement) mini project be modified and made flexible?

No, an intern would be required to ensure timely completion and submission of assignments, MFPE, and preparation required prior to the sessions.

43. What will be the mode of communication after joining the Cognizant internship program?

Once the intern is onboarded to the Cognizant internship program, all communications will be sent to the cognizant email id.

44. Can a preferred location for the internship be opted for?

Internship training location is solely based on the business requirement and candidate's availability to relocate for Internship as shared by TPO.

45. Does the training provide practical exposure to projects within the firm?

Yes, training provides practical exposure to projects which includes real time business scenarios.

46. How to log in to the Onboarding portal?

An intern will receive an email on their personal email account regarding the creation of a password and the procedure for logging in. If interns need more clarity, they can clarify their doubts in the induction session.

47. How will the communication regarding the track and training be passed on?

The details of the track and training will be communicated to intern's Cognizant's mail ID. No communication will be sent to their personal mail IDs.

48. Can trainees choose the course or technology for training in accordance with their preference?

No, technology mapping is based on business requirement and the skill profiling of the intern.

49. Can the trainee be provided with the syllabus and the content about the training they will undergo?

Yes, the Batch owner will share the curriculum and the track details prior to the training start date. We will also have a track walkthrough as part of the induction process.

50. Whom to contact in case of resignation from the internship?

An intern should reach out to the respective batch owner who will guide through the process.

51. Can the domain be changed after joining the internship?

Domain change may not be recommended as mapping will be done based on business requirements and skill profiling.

52. What is the importance of projects in the curriculum?

Projects in the curriculum act as simulators for working on live projects. Projects give exposure to work on business cases from the mapped business unit.

53. What is the pre-requisite for attending the Stage1/Delta assessment?

Interns should complete all hands-on and mock assessments, which are the prerequisites for attending the stage1/Delta assessment.

54. What are the tools & platforms for Intern training?

Self-learning will have to be covered through Udemy with support from external trainers/BU SMEs. Hands-on and assessments will have to be taken through the GenC Learn platform.

55. When will interns get access to Udemy and the learning platform?

Udemy access will be provided immediately upon joining and Cognizant ID is created, and GenC Learn platform access will be provided once the track is assigned, and the training start date is fixed.

56. What if the trainee is unable to complete the learning for the day/week?

The intern will be marked as behind schedule in the report and will not be eligible for the Coding Challenge/Assess type 1. They will have to take the Coding Challenge/Assess type 1 in the catch-up calendar.

57. What are the several types of assessments?

There will be interim and final evaluations, which vary across skill tracks. This information will be communicated during the curriculum walkthrough call before you start your training.

58. Are trainees eligible to receive additional time for their assignment if necessary?

The curriculum is designed to complete all the assignments within the given timeframe. In case of any pending assignments, candidates can complete them over the weekend.

59. Is it possible for trainees to have more time for tasks given their college work as well?

No, candidates are expected to complete the tasks within the given timeframes. If candidates are behind schedule, they will have to catch up along with the current week's schedule.

60. Is there an internship completion certificate provided to interns?

No certificate will be provided for Internship completion. However, a completion mailer will be sent 1 week prior to joining as Full time Employee.

61. How will the candidate get to know the FTE joining details post completion of internship?

The internship completion mailing process is automated, and the mailer will be sent one week prior to joining as a full-time employee.

62. Can the base location be changed? Will the same location be carried forward post joining as an FTE?

Preferred locations are collected from candidates, and the joining location will be finalized based on business demand and feasibility. The FTE joining location will be purely based on business requirements.

63. How much time is required to join as a full-time employee after the completion of the internship?

Joining as a full-time employee is solely based on business demand, which can be within two months from internship completion.

64. Will Udemy access will be available even after the internship?

Yes, Udemy access is provided to the Cognizant email ID, which will be temporarily terminated after the internship and reactivated once the candidate joins as an FTE.

65. What is considered successful completion of the internship?

Completion criteria will be aligned with the SL mapping and learning track, which will be oriented during track induction.

66. Will a trainer be available for training Interns?

Most of the learning takes place in self-paced mode. There is also conceptual learning and guided practice covered by a trainer.

67. Is the behavioral session mandatory, and what is its importance?

Yes, apart from technical learning, we groom candidates in behavioral aspects like business communication, client interfacing, telephone etiquette, etc., which will help them handle calls and other activities in projects.

68. What is the importance of mentor/SME sessions?

Mentor/SMEs come from the business and provide inferences and examples from live projects.

69. In case an intern faces a medical exigency lasting more than two weeks, will the intern be terminated or given another chance?

The candidate may not be able to catch up with the pending learning, and we may have to map them to upcoming batches.

70. Will the candidate submit TruTime (to track your time in office) during the internship?

Yes, candidates are required to submit TruTime and timesheets during the internship.

71. Whom to reach out to for clarity regarding Tru time and Timesheet?

Batch owner is the primary POC to clarify any questions on Tru time and Timesheet.

72. Can Interns learn outside of Udemy?

Interns are free to learn outside of Udemy; however, learning completion percentage is based on the schedule assigned to them.

73. Where will the Interns take assessments, and are the assessments proctored?

Interns take assessments on the GenC Learn platform/ Moodle, and all assessments are physically proctored.

74. Will there be any transport provided to commute to the Cognizant offices during the internship?

Shuttle services are available at limited locations, and this information will be communicated during your onboarding or initial meetings with the Cognizant Internship team. For other locations, interns should plan their own commute.

75. Will there be any food provided at Cognizant offices during the internship?

Interns can avail food in the office cafeteria at their own expense. The cafeteria offers a variety of meals and snacks for them to enjoy during their break.

76. Whom can we reach in case of queries?

For **queries related to Onboarding**, please write to GenCInternsCSDSupp@cognizant.com

For queries related to **Internship skilling**, please follow the line of communication mentioned below:

- If you have any queries related to internship program, please write to **Kiran** (Kirankumar.Lakku@Cognizant.com) and **Srini** (Srinivasan.Sivaraman@cognizant.com)
- If your queries remain unresolved after one business day, please write to **Prasanna** (PrasannaAnand.RM@Cognizant.com)
- For any escalations, please write to **Kameshwari** (Kameshwari.Rajaveerapadran@cognizant.com)

